County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Bluffton Library
120 Palmetto Way
Bluffton, SC 29910

Monday, October 27, 2025
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/359204

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:04 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson - Virtual
Council Member York Glover - Virtual
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

Absent
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Lawrence McElynn

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Council Member Reitz led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 7:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the minutes from the Special Called County Council meeting October 2, 2025, and Caucus and Council October 13, 2025.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 7:0.

6. Proclamation

a. Presentation of a proclamation recognizing October 23-31 as Red Ribbon Week

Council Member Bartholomew presented a proclamation to the Young Marines recognizing October 23-31 as Red Ribbon Week.

b. Presentation of a proclamation recognizing the 250th anniversary of the Navy

Council Member Passiment presented a proclamation to staff members recognizing the 250th anniversary of the Navy.

c. Presentation of a proclamation for Beaufort County Youth Conference Month

Vice-Chair Tabernik presented a proclamation to Beaufort County Youth recognizing September as Youth Conference Month

d. Presentation of a proclamation for Pan-African Family Empowerment & Land Preservation Network / Help Save Gullah Geechee Land Campaign Month

Council Member Lawson presented a proclamation to Ms. White recognizing October as Pan-African Family Empowerment & Land Preservation Network/Help Save Gullah Geechee Land Campaign Month.

7. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken.

8. Liaison and Committee Reports

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/359204

9. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Public Facilities and Safety Committee

1. Approval to award a contract to Truluck Construction for the Paukie Island Road Culvert Replacement Project ($2,207,788.79).

2. A Contract to O'Quinn Marine Construction Inc. for Melrose Dock Repair Project ($282,695).

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

10. Ordinances for Second Reading:

a. 2025/46: An Ordinance authorizing the execution and delivery of Utility Easement #907041 for Right of Way Owned by Beaufort County known as Dolphin Watch Point Located on Lady's Island

The vote at Public Facilities Committee Meeting on September 15, 2025 - 7:0.
The vote at First Reading and Public Hearing on October 13, 2025 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/46.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

b. 2025/47: An ordinance to appropriate excess funds collected from the 2018 Transportation Sales Tax

The vote at Public Facilities Committee Meeting on September 15, 2025 - 7:0.
The vote at First Reading and Public Hearing on October 13, 2025 - 10:0.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/47.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

c. 2025/48: An Ordinance to appropriate $848,912 to St. James Baptist Church from the established project funds for the associated furniture and fixtures related to the overall project
The vote at Public Facilities Committee Meeting on September 15, 2025 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading and Public Hearing on October 13, 2025 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/48.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

11. Ordinances for First Reading:

a. 2025/49: An Ordinance to amend the business and professional licenses Ordinance, Chapter 18, Article III, Section 18-67(A)(B), Appendix A&B.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on October 6, 2025 - 7:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Howard to approve first reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/49.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 6:3.

12. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY



BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:



_____
Octavia L. Evans, Senior Administrative Specialist
Ratified: November 10, 2025